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(54) **CLUB RACK FOR GOLF CART BAG**

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(57) **ABSTRACT**

This club rack ("RACK") is designed for use primarily by golfers who have limited shoulder motion and have difficulty in lifting golf clubs out of a golf bag. It is designed to minimize the motion required to use a golf club AND to easily be used with a golf bag mounted on a motorized golf cart. The RACK is a single piece non-metallic assembly consisting of a vertical bracket and two horizontal shelves and designed to hold up to 8 clubs. Once the golf bag is placed on the cart, the rack is placed in front of the bag so that the bottom portion of the vertical bracket extends beneath the front lip of the bag well of the cart. The golf bag and RACK are then both secured to the cart using the strap that is part of the cart.

Illustration of Club Rack mounted to Golf Bag on Golf Cart

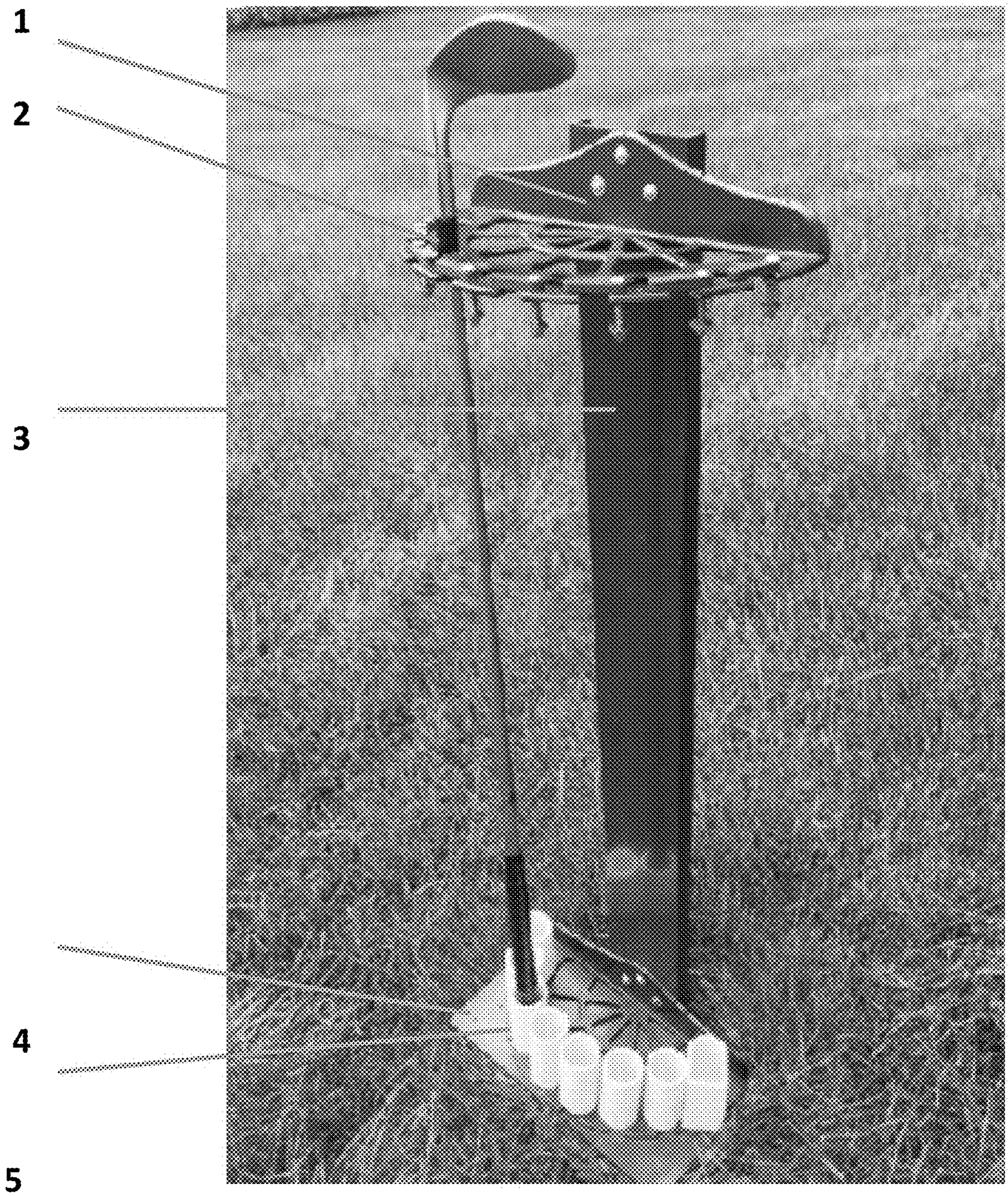

Fig. 1

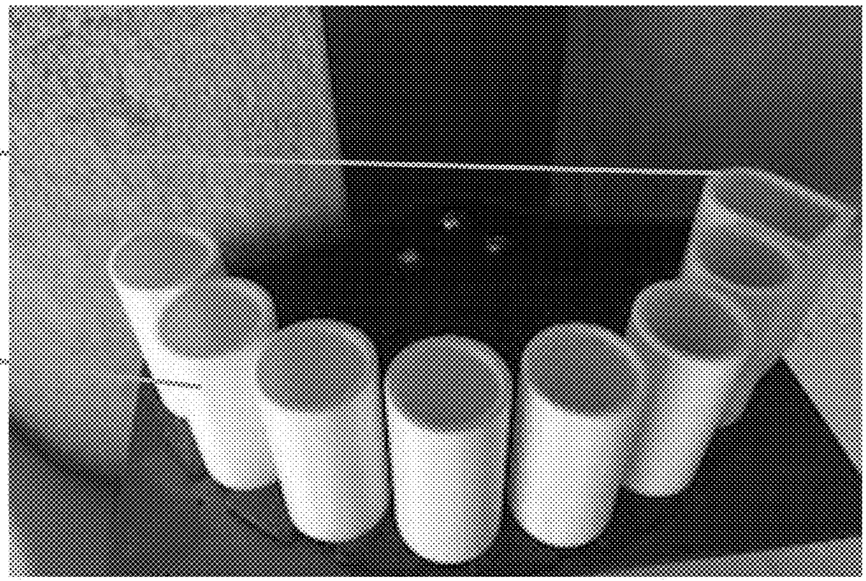

Fig. 2

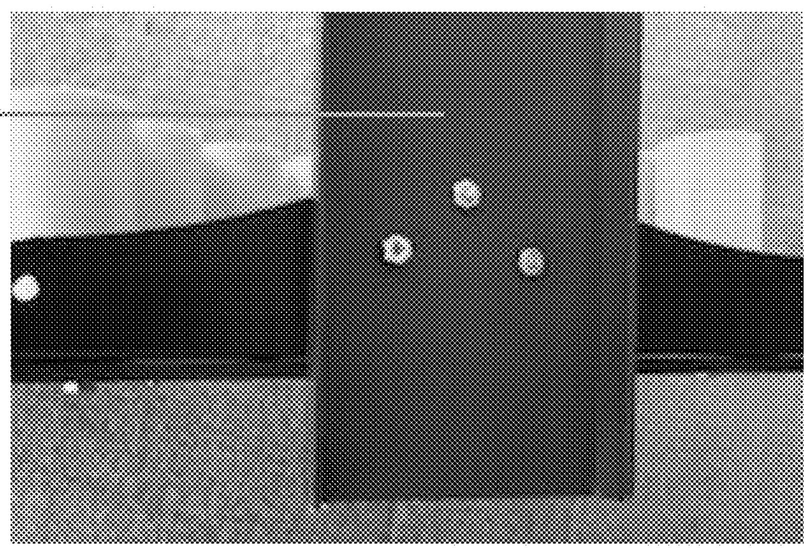

Fig. 3

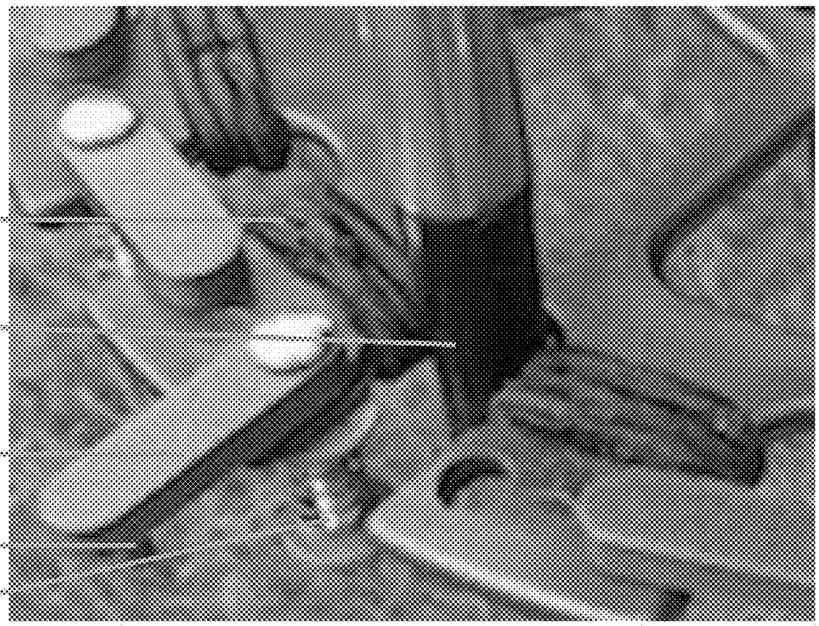

Fig. 4 - Gate OPENED

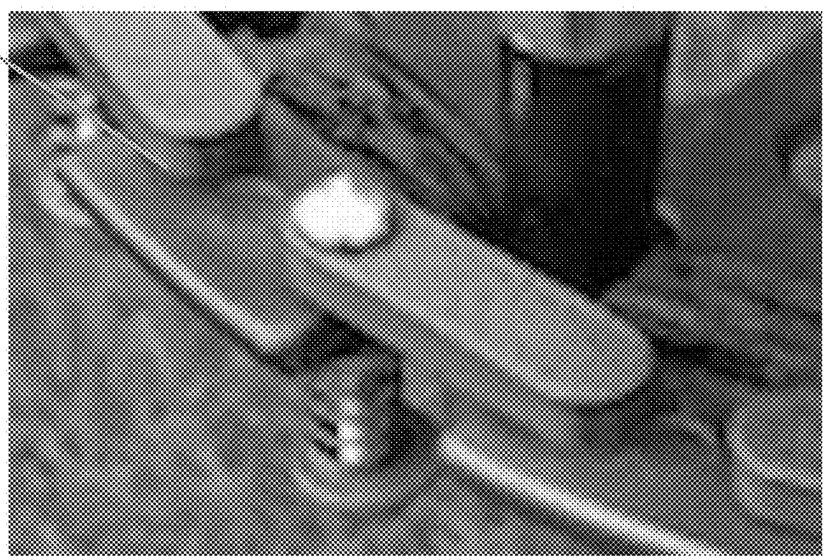

Fig. 5 - Gate CLOSED

Illustration of Club Rack mounted to Golf Bag on Golf Cart

Fig. 6

CLUB RACK FOR GOLF CART BAG

BACKGROUND OF THE INVENTION

1. Field of the Invention

[0001] The present invention generally relates to a rack designed to hold up to 8 golf clubs in combination with a golf bag and a motorized golf cart. The majority of motorized golf carts are designed to hold up to two golf bags in a vertical orientation. The bottom of each bag is lowered into a well and then the top of the bag is secured by a flat belt. To remove a club from the bag, the golfer must hold the club and lift it up and out of the bag, a distance of approximately 2½ feet.

[0002] Golfers who have limited shoulder motion have difficulty in lifting golf clubs out of a golf bag. The present invention is designed to minimize the motion required to use a golf club by requiring the club to be lifted only 3 inches. The present invention (rack) is a single piece non-metallic assembly consisting of a vertical bracket and two horizontal shelves and designed to hold up to 8 clubs. Once the golf bag is placed on the cart, the rack is placed in front of the bag so that the bottom portion of the vertical bracket extends beneath the front lip of the bag well of the cart. The golf bag and rack are then both secured to the cart using the flat belt that is part of the cart.

2. Description of the Prior Art

[0003] Various apparatuses have been developed to hold golf clubs as stand alone devices or on golf carts. To be used on a golf cart, the golf club holder must be assembled to the cart. To the knowledge of the Applicant, there is no prior art of a rack that is designed to be mounted together with the golf bag to a golf cart and that does not require any assembly. Mounting both the golf bag and the rack to the golf cart as described in the preceding paragraph eliminates the need to transfer items in the golf bag to the rack.

SUMMARY OF THE INVENTION

[0004] The specific components of the Club Rack for Golf Cart Bag ("RACK") are shown in attached FIG. **1**, "DRAWINGSLISTGCRcb CORR". The TOP Shelf (**1**) and BOTTOM shelf (**4**) are assembled to the front side of the Vertical Bracket (**3**). The head end of a golf club is shown positioned in a slot on the TOP Shelf with the GATE (**2**) closed and the grip end positioned in the corresponding HOLDER (**5**) on the BOTTOM Shelf.

[0005] The HOLDERS (**7** & **6**) are designed so that the club handle will not bounce out as the golf cart travels along the course. FIG. **2**, "DRAWINGSLISTGCRcb CORR" (see attached) illustrates the seven non-metallic tubes [HOLDERS (**7**)] and an eighth oblong shaped HOLDER (**6**) to accommodate the different shape grips on most type of putters in use today. The bottom end of each HOLDER is a closed end and used to assemble the HOLDER to the BOTTOM Shelf. The top of each HOLDER is open so the the grip end of a golf club can be slid into the HOLDER.

[0006] As shown in attached FIG. **3** "DRAWINGSLISTGCRcb CORR", the BOTTOM Shelf is assembled to the Vertical Bracket (**3**) so that the BOTTOM shelf will sit on the top of the front lip of the bag well of a typical golf cart and so that the Vertical Bracket will extend below the top of the lip. This element of the design retains the bottom end of the RACK against the lower portion of the golf club bag. The main strap which is part of a typical golf cart is used to retain the upper portions of both the golf club bag and the RACK to the golf cart. Thus the RACK can be quickly and easily attached to the golf club bag.

[0007] FIG. **4**, "DRAWINGSLISTGCRcb CORR" (see attached" is a close-up view of the TOP Shelf with the shaft of a golf club placed in the rounded part of a SLOT (**9**) and with the GATE (**2**) opened to allow removal of the club. The edges of rounded part of each slot are partially lined with a soft rubber material (**8**) to dampen any motion of the club while the golf cart is in motion. The GATE has a rotating spring loaded shaft (**2***b*) on one end and a fixed stud (**2***a*) on the other end. The GATE is positioned by pressing up on the bottom end of the spring loaded shaft and moving the GATE to

[0008] FIG. **5**, "DRAWINGSLISTGCRcb CORR" (see attached" illustrates how the club is held in the SLOT when the GATE is closed. With the GATE closed, the fixed stud (FIG. **4** **2***a*) is secured in a hole on the TOP Shelf. This design ensures that the golf club will be "locked" in place when the GATE is closed and prevents the club from sliding out of the SLOT accidentally during jostling occurring when the cart is in motion.

[0009] To withdraw a club from the RACK, the golfer opens the GATE, lifts the grip end of the club out of the HOLDER, then tilts the club shaft out of the SLOT. To replace the club, the golfer guides the grip end of the club into the HOLDER, slides the shaft into the corresponding slot and closes the GATE. Both of these actions require considerably less arm movement than removing or replacing a club from a standard golf bag.

[0010] FIG. **6**, "DRAWINGSLISTGCRcb CORR" (see attached" shows the RACK mounted to one of the two golf bags on a golf cart. It illustrates that there is access to the golf bag.

BRIEF DESCRIPTION OF THE DRAWINGS

[0011] The present invention is depicted in photos of the prototype unit as follows:

[0012] FIG. **1** is a full view of the present invention (rack) and showing a single golf club positioned in the rack.

[0013] FIG. **2** shows the Bottom Shelf of the rack with the eight Holders for the handle end of the golf clubs.

[0014] FIG. **3** shows the orientation of the Bottom Shelf to the Vertical Bracket.

[0015] FIG. **4** is a close-up view of the shaft of a club in the Slot with the Gate opened.

[0016] FIG. **5** is a close-up view showing the Gate closed.

[0017] FIG. **6** shows the rear of a golf cart with a rack mounted to one of the two bags on the cart.

1. A golf rack for securely holding up to 8 golf clubs, designed to be used with a golf bag on a motorized golf car, constructed with non-metallic materials and not to exceed 10 lbs. in weight, and mounted to a golf bag using the same flat belt that is used to mount to said bag to a motorized golf cart.

2. A golf rack as claimed in claim **1**, comprising of:

a TOP Shelf in the shape of a semi-circle having 8 slots each starting with an open end on the outside edge of said shelf and terminating in a rounded shape designed to accept the shaft portion of each club;

a BOTTOM Shelf, the same size and shape as the TOP shelf, having 8 HOLDERS described in claim **3** and positioned to be in line with the slots in said TOP Shelf;

a VERTICAL BRACKET to which said shelves are assembled to in such a manner that said TOP Shelf is a maximum distance of two inches from the top end of said bracket and said BOTTOM shelf is a maximum distance of 3 inches from the bottom end of said Bracket.

3. A golf rack as claimed in claim **2** wherein

said BOTTOM shelf is positioned as noted in claim **2** so that it sits on the top edge of the bag well and said bottom end of said bracket protrudes into the bag well of a motorized golf cart cart,

the HOLDERS noted in claim **2** are not more than 3 inches in height

7 of which have a cylindrical shape with a 1½ inch inside diameter designed to accept the grip end of a golf club

while the 8th HOLDER is designed to also hold the circular or non-circular shape of the grip of a Putter.

4. A golf rack as claimed in claim **2** wherein

each of the 8 slots of said TOP shelf are wider at the outside edge and terminates with a rounded shape designed to accommodate a range of common diameter golf club shafts,

at the outside edge of said each slots there is a “GATE” which must be positioned away from

the slot to insert or remove a club thru the slot and the repositioned across the slot to prevent the club from sliding out of the slot during the jostling occurring when the cart is in motion.

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